

Matilde Ellen Simonetti, M.Sc.

Ph.D. Candidate

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Education

Ph.D. Student in Psychology

Institute of Psychology

Dissertation: *Statistical word learning in bilinguals: Examining changes in learning behaviour due to differences in language environment*

Supervisors: Dr. Tanja C. Roembke, Prof. Dr. Iring Koch

Planned defence date: Autumn 2026

RWTH Aachen University

November 2022 – Present

M.Sc. in Applied Experimental Psychological Sciences

Final grade: 110/110 *cum laude*

Milan-Bicocca University, Milan, Italy

October 2019 – November 2021

B.Sc. in Psychological Sciences and Techniques

Final grade: 110/110

Milan-Bicocca University, Milan, Italy

October 2016 – November 2019

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Open science badges indicate availability of data, materials, code, and preregistration.



Open Data



Open Materials



Open Code



Preregistered



Preregistered+



Simonetti, M. E., Lorenz, M. G., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2025). The influence of bilingualism on statistical word learning: A registered report. *Royal Society Open Science*. [10.1098/rsos.251768](https://doi.org/10.1098/rsos.251768)



Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2025). How do multiple meanings affect word learning and remapping? *Memory & Cognition*, 1–20. [10.3758/s13421-025-01706-z](https://doi.org/10.3758/s13421-025-01706-z)



Buchanan, E. M., Cuccolo, K., (...) **Simonetti, M. E.**, (...) & Suchow, J. (2025). Measuring the semantic priming effect across many languages. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 1–20. [10.1038/s41562-025-02254-x](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-025-02254-x)

Di Natale, A. F., La Rocca, S., **Simonetti, M. E.**, & Bricolo, E. (2024). Using computer-generated faces in experimental psychology: The role of realism and exposure. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*, 14, 100397. [10.1016/j.chbr.2024.100397](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbr.2024.100397)

Kiyak, C., Deluca, P., Norton, S., **Simonetti, M. E.**, & Preti, E. (2023). The impact of cue-elicited multisensory imagery on alcohol craving: A randomized controlled trial. *European Addiction Research*, 29(5), 353–362. [10.1159/000531844](https://doi.org/10.1159/000531844)

Roembke, T. C., **Simonetti, M. E.**, Koch, I., & Philipp, A. M. (2023). What have we learned from 15 years of research on cross-situational word learning? A focused review. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 14, 1175272. [10.3389/fpsyg.2023.1175272](https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2023.1175272)



Di Natale, A. F., **Simonetti, M. E.**, La Rocca, S., & Bricolo, E. (2023). Uncanny valley effect: A qualitative synthesis of empirical research to assess the suitability of using virtual faces in psychological research. *Computers in Human Behavior Reports*, 10, 100288. [10.1016/j.chbr.2023.100288](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chbr.2023.100288)

Kiyak, C., **Simonetti, M. E.**, Norton, S., & Deluca, P. (2023). The efficacy of cue exposure therapy on alcohol use disorders: A quantitative meta-analysis and systematic review. *Addictive Behaviors*, 139, 107578. [10.1016/j.addbeh.2022.107578](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.addbeh.2022.107578)

Book Chapters

Simonetti, M. E., & Roembke, T. C. (in press). Cross-situational word learning. In *Encyclopedia of Language and Linguistics* (3rd ed.). Elsevier. [10.1016/B978-0-323-95504-1.00808-5](https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-0-323-95504-1.00808-5)

Preprints and Manuscripts in Preparation



Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (in preparation). The “bilingual advantage” in word learning: A meta-analysis. [Manuscript in preparation].



Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (in preparation). Online competition among multiple word-object mappings in cross-situational word learning. [Manuscript in preparation].



Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (in preparation). The impact of language switching on statistical word learning. [Manuscript in preparation].

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Empirical Practical Training, RWTH Aachen University, Aachen, Germany Summer Semester 2024 & Summer Semester 2025
Supervisor: Dr. Tanja C. Roembke

Tutor, Cognitive Psychology, Università degli Studi di Pavia, Italy Summer Semester 2022
Supervisor: Prof. Emanuela Bricolo

Supervision

Supervision of bachelor's theses, RWTH Aachen University, Aachen, Germany Summer Semester 2025 & Winter Semester 2025
Second supervisor: Dr. Tanja C. Roembke

Supervision of UROP exchange students, RWTH Aachen University, Aachen, Germany Summer Semester 2023 & Summer Semester 2024
First supervisor: Dr. Tanja C. Roembke

Supervision of master's thesis, Milan-Bicocca University, Milan, Italy Summer Semester 2022
First supervisor: Prof. Emanuela Bricolo

Service

Peer reviewer

- *Learning and Instruction*
- *Bilingualism: Language and Cognition*
- *Cognitive Development*
- *Cerebral Cortex*
- *CogSci 2024*

- CogSci 2025
- CogSci 2026

Symposium organisation

- *New Trends in Word Learning: The Role of Prior Knowledge*, TeaP (Tagung experimentell arbeitender Psychologen), Tübingen, Germany 2026
- *New Directions in the Study of Bilingual Language Control*, TeaP (Tagung experimentell arbeitender Psychologen), Tübingen, Germany 2026
- *The Impact of Language Experience on Learning and Memory*, TeaP (Tagung experimentell arbeitender Psychologen), Regensburg, Germany 2024

Conference organisation

- ADok (Allgemeine Psychologie für Doktorandinnen und Doktorandinnen), Aachen, Germany 2025

Conference Presentations

Talks

Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2026). *The impact of language switching on cross-situational word learning*. [Talk]. TeaP (Tagung experimentell arbeitender Psychologen), Tübingen, Germany.

Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2025). *Is there a bilingual advantage in word learning? A meta-analysis*. [Talk]. ISB15 (International Symposium on Bilingualism), Donostia-San Sebastián, Spain.

Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2025). *No evidence for bilingual advantage in statistical word learning*. [Talk]. TeaP (Tagung experimentell arbeitender Psychologen), Frankfurt, Germany.

Simonetti, M. E., Lorenz, M. G., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2024). *The “bilingual advantage” in word learning: A meta-analysis*. [Talk]. ADok (Allgemeine Psychologie für Doktorandinnen und Doktoranden), Heidelberg, Germany.

Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., Lorenz, M. G., & Roembke, T. C. (2024). *The impact of overlapping mappings on the acquisition and retrieval of word meanings*. [Talk]. PiF (Psycholinguistics in Flanders), Brussels, Belgium.

Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2024). *The “bilingual advantage” in word learning: A meta-analysis*. [Talk]. TeaP (Tagung experimentell arbeitender Psychologen), Regensburg, Germany.

Simonetti, M. E., Lorenz, M. G., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2023). *The impact of overlapping mappings on the acquisition and retrieval of word meanings*. [Talk]. ESCOP (European Society for Cognitive Psychology), Porto, Portugal.

Simonetti, M. E., Lorenz, M. G., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2023). *The impact of overlapping mappings on the acquisition and retrieval of word meanings*. [Talk]. ADok (Allgemeine Psychologie für Doktorandinnen und Doktoranden), Greifswald, Germany.

Di Natale, A. F., **Simonetti, M. E.**, & Bricolo, E. (2022). *The role of realism and expertise in virtual faces' elaboration*. [Talk]. AIP (Associazione Italiana di Psicologia), Padova, Italy.

Posters

Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2025). *Are meanings of the same word competing with each other in the moment during statistical word learning?* [Poster]. ESCOP (European Society for Cognitive Psychology), Sheffield, United Kingdom.

Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., Lorenz, M. G., & Roembke, T. C. (2024). *The influence of bilingualism on statistical word learning*. [Poster]. Psychonomics, New York, NY, USA.

Simonetti, M. E., Koch, I., & Roembke, T. C. (2023). *Online competition among multiple word-object mappings in cross-situational statistical learning*. [Poster]. TeaP (Tagung experimentell arbeitender Psychologen), Trier, Germany.

Professional Development / Trainings

Autumn School: *Experimental data in social sciences and humanities: Meta-analysis methods*, CNRS Lille, France 8–10 October 2025

Summer School: *Institute of Language, Communication and the Brain Summer School*, CIRM Marseille, France 28 August – 1 September 2023

Summer School: *Multisensory Virtual and Physical Prototyping*, Milan Polytechnic, Italy 18–22 October 2021

Summer School: *Build the New Everything: VR and AR School*, University Milano-Bicocca, Italy 13–17 September 2021

Winter School: *Human Factors in Portable and Wearable Technologies*, University Milano-Bicocca, Italy 27–31 January 2020

Skills

Technical skills: Eye-tracking

Programming skills: Experiment Builder, MATLAB, Python, R; MS Office

Statistical skills: Techniques – frequentist analyses, Bayesian analyses; Programs – RStudio, Jamovi, SPSS

Languages: Italian (mother tongue); English (IELTS 7.5); German (B1, university certificate)

Community Engagement

Member, GeWoNN (German Word Nerd Network)

GeWoNN brings together language and reading researchers working on the German language and provides a forum for discussing research-specific questions and improvements in the field. We value openness, honesty, fairness, and inclusivity, and hope to attract members who are genuinely interested in improving reading research and academia more generally.

<https://sites.google.com/view/gewonn/home?authuser=0>

Member, TRUST Network

The goal of TRUST is to increase the quality of current reading research practices. We aim to establish best-practice and collective research guidelines for the field, providing an optimal, transparent, and sustainable basis for across-lab investigations.

<https://sites.google.com/view/gewonn/trust-network>

Leadership board member, WiCS-Europe+

WiCS-Europe+ organises events for cognitive scientists in Europe and has been present at major international meetings (e.g., ESCoP, ICPS, Psychonomic Society meetings). We are open to new initiatives, activities, and meetings.

<https://www.womenincogsci.org/wics-europe>

Last updated: 10.02.2026